When you evaluate a variable, you get the value referenced by it:

```
answer
# 42
```

If you assign a new value to the variable, the name will then evaluate to that new value:

```
texasRanger = true
texasRanger
# true
```

In CoffeeScript you can assign anything you want to a variable regardless of what was previously assigned to it. Any language that allows this is called *dynamically typed*.

To create a variable, you have to assign a value to it. When you do that, you use an operator.

2.3. Operators

Simple expressions are important, but in order to do things with those expressions (like assign a value to a variable) you need some operators to go with them. CoffeeScript has many operators that work exactly the same as they do in JavaScript:

```
+  -  !  /  %  >  <  >=  <=  .  &&  || *
```

Other operators from JavaScript, such as the ternary operator, are either different or unavailable in CoffeeScript, so for the time being you should avoid using them.

It’s now time to look at the essential operators that provide basic syntax to CoffeeScript, some of the new operators that CoffeeScript introduces, and how operators are used to combine expressions. All of the examples in this section can be run on the CoffeeScript REPL. Type them all into the REPL, see the results, and experiment with them.